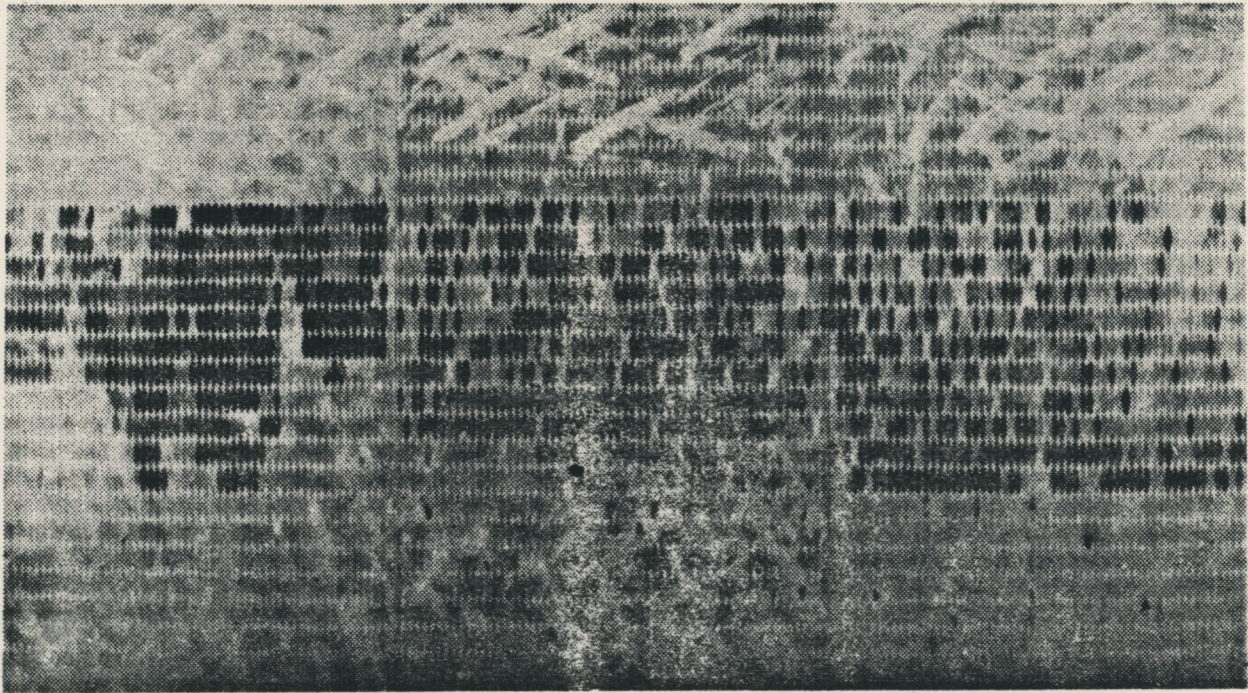


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Art News


SUMIYE OKOSHI, "PLENUM 85"

Sumiye Okoshi at Viridian

One of the most interesting and satisfying of the new shows in the current season is Sumiye Okoshi's "Paper on Canvas" at the Viridian Gallery, 52 West 57 Street, from October 20 to November 7. Widely known in both her native Japan and the United States—this is her second New York City exhibition this year—Ms. Okoshi has evolved a provocative and original technique which fuses her Oriental heritage with a thoroughly contemporary Western sensibility. The dozen or so collages at the Viridian explore the aesthetic possibilities of harmony and contrast in grid patterns of small elliptical paper-cuts pasted on canvas which has first been painted. The texture of the rice paper against the fabric provides a subtle surface contrast, and the water-based acrylics with which the paper has first been painted create another with the oils of the background, giving the ensemble a richness and depth that captivates and holds the viewer. These collage/paintings suggest a million elusive ideas. One can lose oneself in them as in a maze, as the mind wanders behind the surface grid and

through the infinite shifting and changing shapes created by the colors.

Okoshi's use of color is a remarkable achievement, and a highly personal one; rich blues and luminous yellows merge and blend and separate in endless interaction, seeming to change and regroup before the eye as in a kaleidoscope. The patterns which these colors create are alive with a mysterious life of their own. The rice-paper ovals, in finely graded tints tightly aligned, create then, elegant lozenges of background color between them, and the viewer is hypnotized as fore-and background change places.

Okoshi's deceptively simple works all bear the same title, distinguished only by numbers revealing their order of creation. All are called "Plenum," and the name is well chosen. In their serene balance of color and form, these fragments of paper combine in the eye against their monochrome backgrounds to produce a rich plenitude, at once provocative in conception and tranquil in spirit.

—E.F.